

IDS11074
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 5:18 pm CST on Monday 18 May 2026
for the period until midnight CST Thursday 21 May 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A ridge of high pressure lies across SA. A cold front will clip the southeast on Tuesday morning, followed by a high pressure system which becomes dominant. The high is expected to move into the Tasman Sea by Friday as a cold front moves across the Bight.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Monday 18 May until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots north of Cowell to Wallaroo in the late afternoon. Winds turning westerly in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Tuesday 19 May

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning south to southeasterly below 10 knots in the late morning and afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming northeast to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Monday 18 May until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly below 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Tuesday 19 May

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots turning southwesterly early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly below 10 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Central Coast

Forecast for Monday 18 May until midnight

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Tuesday 19 May

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable below 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Northerly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots during the morning then tending northeasterly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Monday 18 May until midnight

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Tuesday 19 May

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly 10 to 15 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to around 1 metre around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable below 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres inshore. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Monday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.